

This was the issue that meant to mark the third in our series of the Spirit of India specials we have released all year to highlight the exceptional people who make up our country.

On the night this special issue was being sent to press, news first came in of a fresh and chilling spate of terror attacks in Mumbai. In a series of strikes meant to spread fear and panic across India's most cosmopolitan city, terrorists attacked several locations in south Mumbai, including its biggest railway terminus and landmark hotels. They fired at commuters inside the railway station, killed dozens of people, including senior policemen, and took hostages in five-star hotels.

We decided to stop the press and change the cover story for this issue, focusing on Mumbai and this fresh assault on India. Editor Prabhu Chawla happened to be in Mumbai on the night of the attacks and, along with the rest of the INDIA TODAY bureau, worked through the night to put together the cover story. This has been a year of repeated assaults on the Indian nation. Our country is today in a state of war against these enemies of our state and must respond like it does at a time of an attack on its sovereignty and integrity.

The rest of the issue focuses on the Spirit of India series which had kicked off with "50 Pioneers of Change" and was followed by a special called "Transforming India", a range of distinguished commentators across all walks of life sharing with us their vision for the India of tomorrow. In the third of the series, we recognise some of the most unusual and successful Indian entrepreneurs who post-liberalisation identified opportunities in the new economy and created successful businesses.

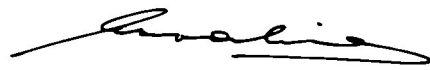
Celebrating enterprise and business when the world is struggling to come to terms with a severe economic and financial crisis may seem contradictory. In the wake of the banking meltdown, many have declared unbridled capitalism as dead. Yet, I believe there is no better time to commemo-

rate the sheer boldness of enterprise; the history of global business teaches us that some of the most successful ideas in business—and its biggest corporations—have taken off and flourished during times of economic hardship.

There are many successful new entrepreneurs in India but we have profiled 50 of them, most of whom are not so well-known but illustrate the new spirit of enterprise in India. We have divided them into three categories. There are the Trailblazers, who have created or engineered a new area of business, who have not merely identified a niche market, but created the niche itself. The Accelerators are those who, while remaining in conventional business, have used the thriving environment around the Indian economy in the last decade to maximise their advantage. The Innovators complete the list, those men and women who have devised new technologies that have filled a gap and in doing so, changed the way their business is run.

Naturally, we have ended up with a colourful and varied list: among others, there are hotel promoters, event managers, diamond specialists, ebusiness gurus, wine-makers and even some who have made their fortune from answering telephone calls. The Spirit of India section was put together by Executive Editor Kaveree Bamzai and her young and energetic team of Associate Copy Editor Chitra Subramanyam and Senior Correspondent Purvi Malhotra. Our correspondents and photographers nationwide met with each of these 50 remarkable people. Each entrepreneur's story is a life-lesson in itself.

Indian enterprise is legendary and the envy of many in the world. I believe there is a great difference between India and China. India has great entrepreneurs or companies who are acclaimed globally. China has great industries but their companies or entrepreneurs are hardly known. It's an advantage we should never lose. I'm sure that in spite of these heinous terrorist attacks our enterprise and resilience will pull us through.



(Aroon Purie)

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